

TV SHOW

The Boys S2

★★★★☆ | Prime Video's *The Boys* is anything but a straight-forward superhero TV show. We watched all 8 episodes of the second season, and we can definitely say that Season 2 of *The Boys* is one of the best and most thrilling television shows of 2020. Superheroes or not! That is great praise indeed but the show just is that good. It's tighter than the first season and knows exactly where it's going. The first season did falter in a few side plots but the second season is laser-focused in its goal. The one thing that we must warn fans of the comic book is that the show is completely different from the comic to the point that apart from the names of the characters, everything has been changed to fit the smaller screen.



The season kicks off right where we left off at the conclusion of the final episode of season one. Butcher knows that his wife Becca is alive and in hiding. After having thought that she was murdered by the Homelander in

season one, Butcher is desperate to get her back. The rest of the team are lying low after the murder of Vought exec Madeline Stilwell. Coming to The Seven, the world's premiere superhero team now has a new addition in the form of Stormfront. The character was a male Nazi sympathizer in the comics and was not as involved in the main team as much as this version of the character is. But, the sinister nature of a gender-swapped Stormfront adds a really intriguing twist to the character. The introduction of Giancarlo Esposito as the main man in charge of the Vought corporation was genius casting as his cold and calculating demeanour lends itself very well to the character he plays.

Even though *The Boys* Season 2 has taken a drastic U-turn from the comic books, it manages to carve out its own world and story. Even though the violence is cartoonish and gruesome, it doesn't take away from the clear good and evil story that *The Boys* Season 2 is trying to tell.

COMIC

Thor (2020)

★★★★☆ | Thor is the new king of Asgard, and the Allfather, so it is a much more serious and powerful version of Thor than the one that we see in the movies. The Bifrost is secured by fan favorite Lady Sif, and not Heimdall. The golden towers of Asgard have been replaced with more sombre constructions of stone and wood. It is an all new universe, but some things stay the same. Tony Stark still manages to scribble a cheeky message to Thor by writing on the side of his hammer with a sharpie. Across the issues, the hammer is a constraint problem, Mjolnir is growing increasingly heavier, and there seem to be some cosmic circumstances that are causing Thor to slip. Thor goes down a weird little path in this one, as Galactus shows up, appearing to be on the run from something that is even more sinister and



evil, the Star Plague, a reality distorting void in space that can eat up entire universes. Galactus was the only survivor of the Star Plague before, and now needs to feed on planets with special properties, that Silver Surfer has kept long hidden from Galactus. Devouring

these planets will allow Galactus to become even more powerful, and just capable enough to take on the Star Plague. Thor is made into a herald of Galactus, which is what makes this series so interesting. Thor goes ahead in front of Galactus, attempting to save the citizens of a planet before allowing Galactus to feed. On the way, the tension between Thor and Galactus is explored in many interesting ways. It is not entirely clear who controls whom, and the meaning of rank goes for a toss when a god and king is also a herald.

Thor has just the right mix of things that makes a comic book work. A wide range of characters from the universe are pulled in and used as pieces in a big battle, which seems to be good and evil teaming up to take on even more evil. The storyline explores a crazy situation where the a well-known protagonist is given a fundamentally novel role. It takes the most important elements of Thor to make it extremely familiar, at the same time, it is just different enough to be a refreshing take. We cannot wait to see where this one goes next.